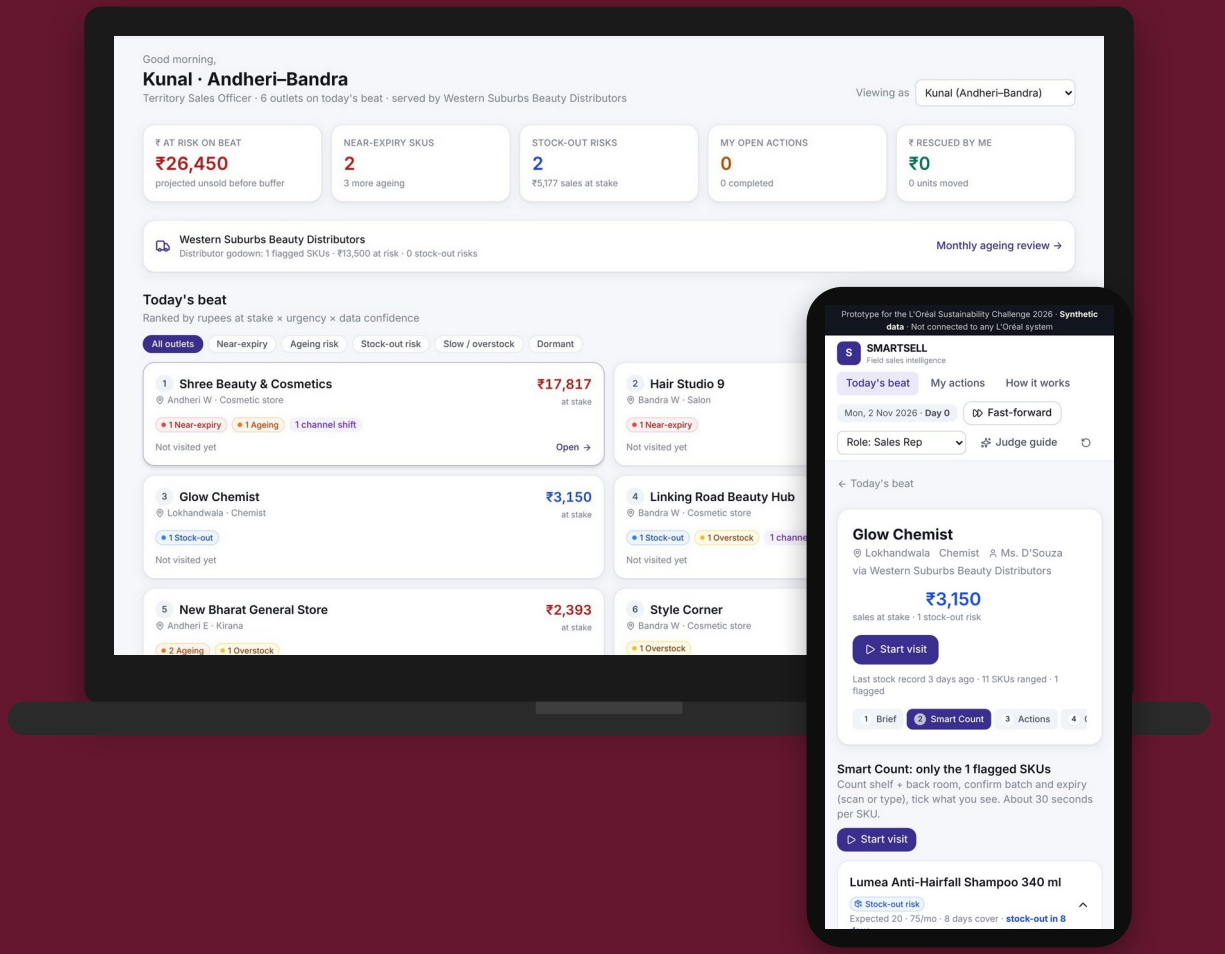
L'ORÉAL | SUSTAINABILITY CHALLENGE 2026 · SALES TRACK

SMARTSELL

Turning field sales into a growth and sustainability engine

Move from selling more inventory into the channel to moving the right inventory to the right customer, at the right place and at the right time.



LIVE PROTOTYPE

smartsell-loreal.vercel.app

All prototype data is synthetic

L'ORÉAL

Less waste and more growth come from the same move: acting on the shelf before the order

01 PROBLEM

≈2.5% of revenue

≈1.5% returned, expired or damaged plus ≈1% to handle it (case). Cutting orders only swaps waste for stock-outs.

02 INSIGHT

Decided at the order, found at the return

Reps visit the shop many times in between, but nothing asks them to act. Quick commerce is widening the gap.

03 SOLUTION

A 4-minute visit routine

See the at-risk SKUs, get ₹ at risk and days to act, take the cheapest sanctioned fix, rebalance across the beat, order to what will sell.

04 IMPACT

≈₹18 cr a year, base case

About 3× its cost over 3 years (illustrative). In our live simulation, returns fell from 1.6% to 0.9% of sell-out.

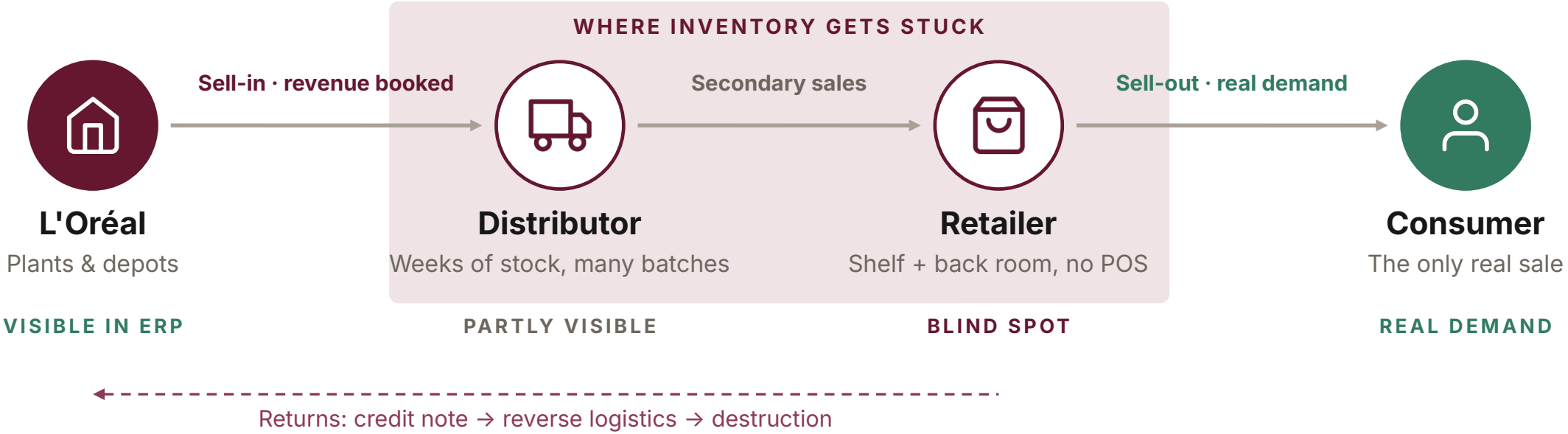
THE ASK

A 16-week, two-city pilot against control territories with clear scale and stop criteria. We need one distributor-data extract and a willing ASM.

Sources: L'Oréal Sales Track case (≈1.5%, ≈1%); financials are illustrative estimates (Appendix C). Prototype data is synthetic.

L'ORÉAL

Every expired unit was sold once, and paid for twice



≈1.5%

of revenue returned, expired or damaged

Case data ("capped" at ≈1.5%)

≈1%

more to handle, reverse-ship and destroy it

Case data

≈₹148 cr

a year at L'Oréal India's scale

Illustrative: 2.5% × ₹5,925 cr FY25 net sales

Sources: L'Oréal Sustainability Challenge 2026 Sales Track case, p.2 (≈1.5% "capped", ≈1%). L'Oréal India FY25 net sales ₹5,925 cr (PTI via The Week, 3 Oct 2025). ₹148 cr is illustrative and assumes the case percentages apply to L'Oréal India.

ROOT CAUSE

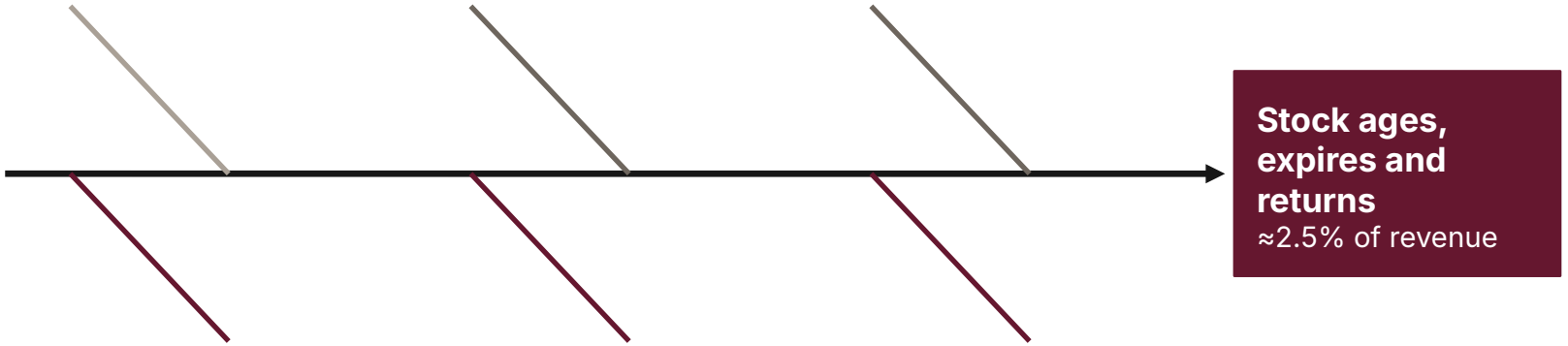
L'ORÉAL

Waste is a visibility and execution problem, not just a forecasting problem

Demand forecasting
Central forecasts can't see outlet sell-out or batch age

Visibility
No batch-age or sell-out view at the outlet

Product velocity
Quick commerce and seasons shift demand faster than norms



Stock ages, expires and returns
≈2.5% of revenue

Distributor ordering
Orders sized by habit, schemes and period-end loading

Retailer inventory
Same range for every outlet; old batches hidden at the back

Field execution
No trigger, no sanctioned actions, sell-in-only targets

● Rep controls it ● Partly ● Little control

WHY "JUST ORDER LESS" FAILS

30 → 21 days

Dabur halted primary sales for 7–8 days to cut distributor stock, and guided to a revenue decline (Q2 FY25).

≈1 in 3

shoppers facing a stock-out switch brand or don't buy at all (global study).

KEY INSIGHT

Waste is decided when the order is taken and discovered when the return arrives. Nothing in today's visit asks the rep to look, tells them what they may do, or rewards them for doing it.

Sources: Dabur Q2 FY25 inventory correction (Sharekhan, 30 Oct 2024; Baroda Securities, 31 Oct 2024). Out-of-stock shopper response: Gruen, Corsten & Bharadwaj, GMA/FMI/CIES 2002 (global, not India). Rep-influence ratings are our assessment.

OUR STRATEGIC SOLUTION

L'ORÉAL

SMARTSELL turns every visit into early detection and the right action

INPUTS

Distributor DMS: stock and invoices

Rep Smart Count + barcode and batch scan

12 simple field signals

Online / quick-commerce trend

→

01 Stock Intelligence

Pre-visit brief, Smart Count, batch and expiry capture, stock-flow sell-out

02 Risk Engine

FEFO projected waste, ₹ at risk, days to act, stock-out and channel-shift detection

03 Action Engine

8-step intervention ladder, transfer matching, order guardrail, approvals

04 Manager Intelligence

Territory risk, approvals, repeat offenders, scorecards, outcomes vs business-as-usual

→

WHO ACTS ON IT

Field rep
today's actions

ASM
approvals, scorecard

Distributor
transfer tasks

Q-comm KAM
channel-shift flags

WHY IT IS THE RIGHT ANSWER

✓ **Directly answers the case** ✓ **Empowers the existing salesforce** ✓ **Balances growth and sustainability** ✓ **Measurable** ✓ **Demonstrable today**

Design principle: a layer on L'Oréal's existing SFA/DMS, not a replacement. Rules-based and explainable; machine learning only where it earns its place (phase 3).

L'ORÉAL

A closed loop the rep runs in about four extra minutes per flagged outlet

THE LOOP **Capture → Detect → Recommend → Execute → Measure → Learn**

01	02	03	04	05	06
Pre-visit brief	**Shelf walk**	**Back room**	**Retailer chat**	**Order moment**	**Day-end sync**
30 s	60–90 s	60 s	60 s	30 s	auto
Phone shows the 5–10 SKUs predicted at risk	Dust, faded packs, same facings as last time	Unopened cartons, oldest batch codes	"What aren't customers asking for?"	Guardrail: suggested vs asked quantity	Escalations to ASM, distributor, KAM

≤4 min
extra at a flagged outlet (design target)

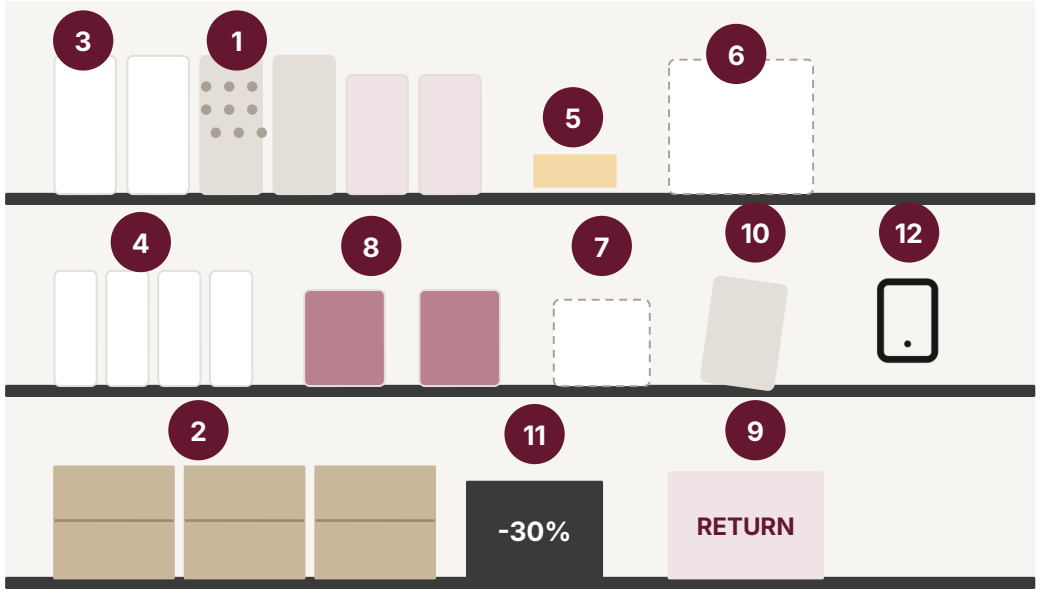
0 min
extra at healthy outlets

5–10
SKUs counted, not the whole shop

Design target of ≤4 extra minutes is an assumption and a pilot stop criterion. Segment lengths are indicative. Case question A: "At which points during a retailer/distributor visit can slow-moving or ageing stock be spotted?"

L'ORÉAL

Twelve simple signals, routed to the person who can fix them



1 Dust / faded packs
2 Unopened outer cartons
3 Same count as last visit
4 Old batch hidden at back
5 Old MRP / old pack design
6 Behind the counter / off-shelf
7 No or damaged tester
8 "Customers don't ask for it"
9 Retailer wants to return
10 Dented, leaking, heat-damaged
11 Competitor running a heavy scheme
12 Shoppers buy it on quick commerce

Flag / action	Rep	Distributor	ASM	Brand	Q-comm KAM
Rotate shelf, eye level, pause this SKU's re-order, verify count	●				
Transfer between outlets	○	●	●		
Sampling, schemes, end-of-life (budget)	○		●	○	
Godown FEFO and monthly ageing review		●	○		
Same SKU slow in 3+ outlets: range or shade issue			○	●	
Demand moving to quick commerce	○				●

● owns or approves ○ proposes or is informed

Transfers above ₹10,000, any scheme, sampling budget and end-of-life need ASM approval.

Case question A: "What simple signals (e.g., shelf dust, unsold cartons, retailer feedback) should be flagged, and to whom?" Signals adjust the sales estimate; only batch data can trigger near-expiry.

L'ORÉAL

Rupees at risk and days to act, not a black-box score

Shree Beauty · Lumea shampoo 340 ml · 120 units · 20 a month · expiry in 105 days

₹14,700
at risk today

75 days
left to act

70 units
projected unsold

TODAY

50 sell before the buffer date | **70 projected unsold → ₹14,700**

Today 2 Nov 2026 → sell-by buffer 16 Jan 2027 (75 days) → expiry 15 Feb 2027

IF THE SAME SHELF HAD BEEN CAUGHT 150 DAYS EARLIER

All 120 sell in time → ₹0 at risk, every option still open

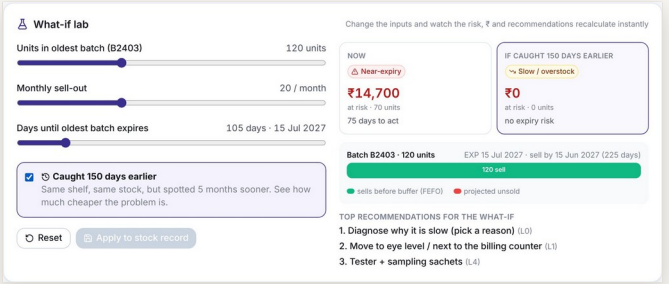
HOW EACH SKU IS SCORED

1 Velocity
monthly sell-out ÷ 30 (stock-flow)

2 FEFO projection
oldest batch first, until expiry – buffer

3 ₹ at risk
projected unsold × unit value

4 Priority
₹ at stake × urgency × data confidence

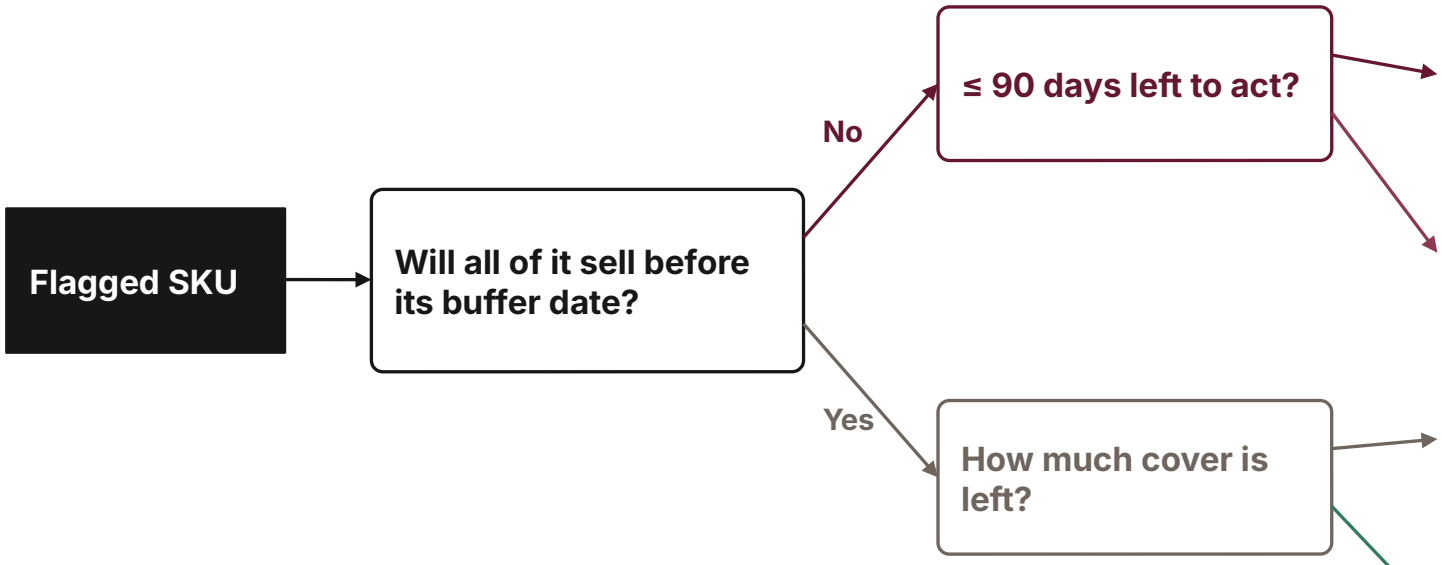


Live what-if lab: drag stock, sales and expiry

Parameters are assumptions to calibrate in the pilot: 30-day sellable buffer at outlets, 120 days at distributors; 30-day cover norm; reorder at ≤14 days. Example uses synthetic data from the live prototype.

L'ORÉAL

Cheapest fix first: near-expiry needs speed, slow-moving needs diagnosis



Near-expiry (≤90 days to act)
Where can it sell before it's too late?
Speed: pause re-order, transfer to the fastest outlets, approved bundle, end-of-life if <30 days

Ageing risk (>90 days to act)
Fix demand while options are cheap
Visibility, sampling, cap re-orders, rebalance surplus

Slow / overstock (>2× norm)
Why isn't it selling here?
Diagnose first, no discount: placement, tester, range fix, then rebalance

Stock-out risk (≤14 days)
Protect the sale
Source from surplus outlets first, then replenish to demand

THE 8-STEP LADDER · CHEAPEST, LEAST BRAND-RISKY FIRST

L6: last resort, never Luxe or Derma

L0 Verify / diagnose	L1 Rotate & re-place	L2 Pause re-order	L3 Rebalance	L4 Activate demand	L5 Approved bundle	L6 Approved scheme	L7 End-of-life	L8 Return
₹0	₹0	₹0	~3% logistics	Budget	Bundle cost	Trade spend	~50% margin	Full loss

Case question B: "What specific on-ground actions would you use to move slow SKUs? What can we do differently for a near-expiry SKU versus a slow-moving one?" Costs and uplifts are assumptions to validate in the pilot.

IN THE FIELD

L'ORÉAL

Four outlets, four different right answers

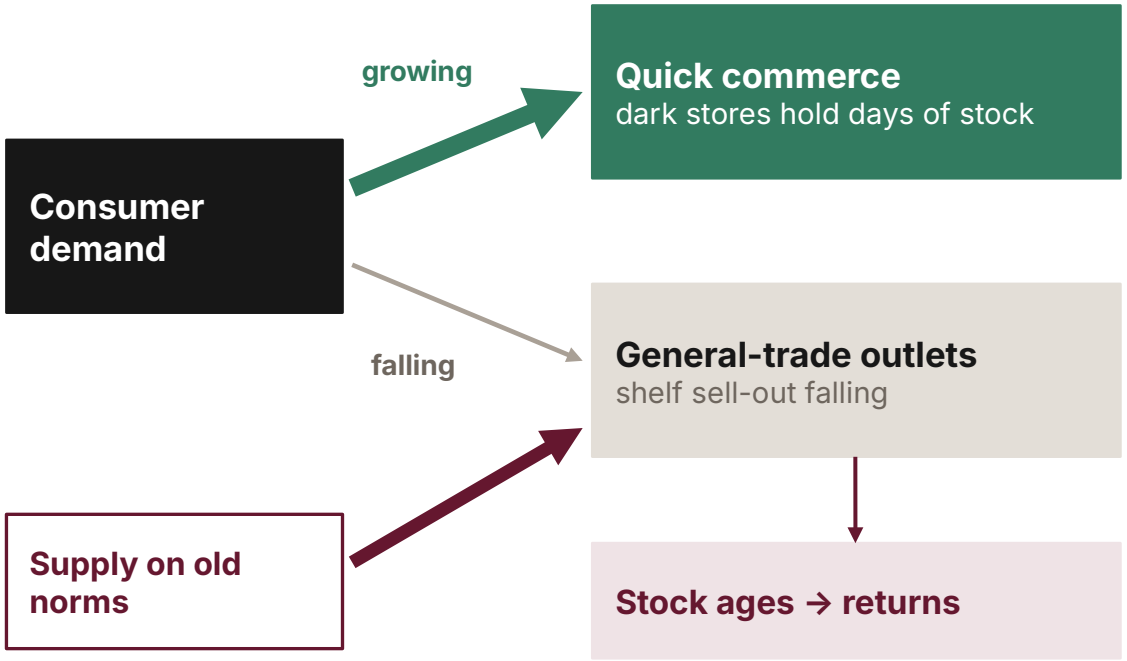
OUTLET	BEFORE		WHAT SMARTSELL RECOMMENDS	AFTER
Shree Beauty ANDHERI · NEAR-EXPIRY	**₹14,700** at risk: ≈70 of 120 shampoo units won't sell in time	→	Pause re-order (retailer asked for 24 more) and transfer 66 units to Glow Chemist, 8 days from running out	**₹840** at risk; a stock-out avoided
Sai Kirana MALAD · SLOW-MOVING	**240 days** of cover: premium Vitamin C serum, healthy shelf life	→	Diagnose: wrong outlet profile. Move to the counter, cap re-orders, move 18 units to CarePoint Chemist	**₹0 discount** cash freed; sells where it fits
Powai Wellness Chemist POWAI · STOCK-OUT RISK	**6 days** of cover: face wash at 60 a month; retailer asked for only 24	→	Replenish 60 units, sized to demand plus lead time (no surplus nearby to transfer)	**Shelf full** lost sales protected
Galleria counter POWAI · LUXE GUARDRAIL	**25% off** discount requested on a slow luxury fragrance	→	Blocked by the brand guardrail; manager redirects to a beauty-advisor day and sample vials	**No price cut** brand equity protected

All four examples are seeded scenarios in the live prototype (synthetic data). Transfers are capped at what the recipient can sell before the batch's buffer date, so waste is never pushed downstream.

L'ORÉAL

Quick commerce becomes a planning signal, not a source of waste

WHAT CHANGES



OUR APPROACH

01 Detect
Outlet sell-out −20%+ in 3 months while the brand grows 20% + online, or the rep's signal

02 Resize
Order guardrail uses a 21-day cover norm, not 30: stop loading general trade

03 Hand off
Flag to the quick-commerce KAM and demand planning: move allocation online

04 Route
Fresh stock follows demand online; ageing stock is rebalanced within general trade, never dumped

In the app: 5 SKU-outlets flagged as shifting online; ₹23,160 of general-trade loading avoided against retailer asks (synthetic).

≈18%
of FMCG sales in India's top-8 metros are online; >¾ of that is quick commerce *NielsenIQ, Q4 2025*

Priority
L'Oréal named quick commerce a focus for India growth *Business Standard, Oct 2026*

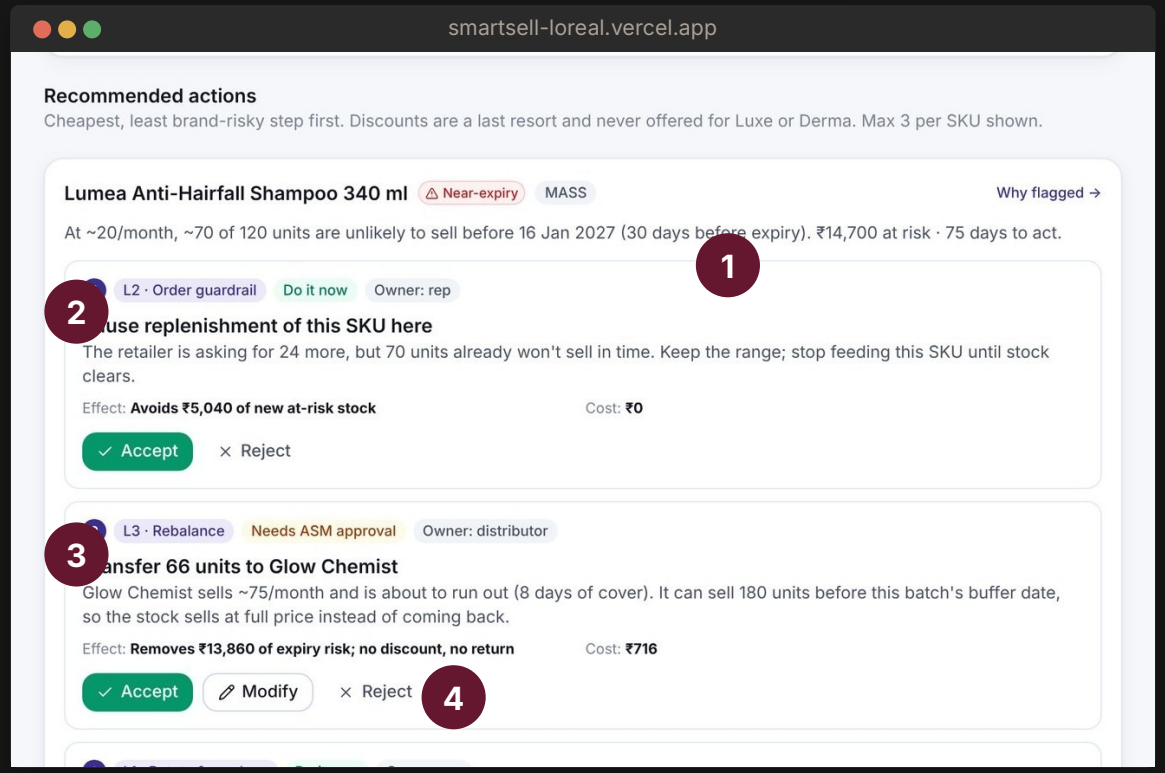
30 → 21 days
distributor stock cut at Dabur after demand moved channels *Brokerage notes, Oct 2024*

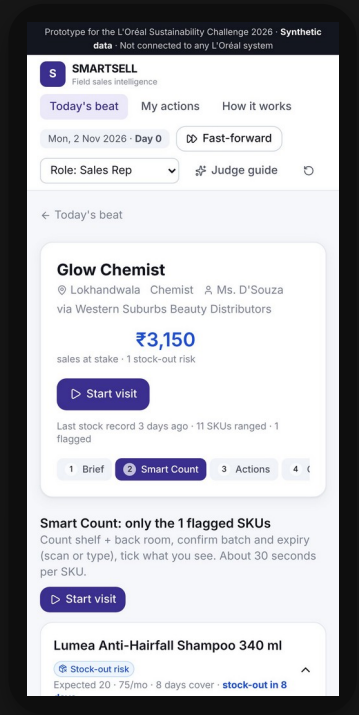
Dumping
distributors allege near-expiry stock is offloaded on quick commerce at deep discounts *AICPDF, Nov 2024*

Sources: NielsenIQ India FMCG Snapshot Q4 2025 (Mar 2026); Business Standard, 25 Oct 2026; Dabur Q2 FY25 brokerage notes (Oct 2024); AICPDF via Storyboard18 (Nov 2024), allegation. Diagram is conceptual. Online growth figures in the prototype are synthetic.

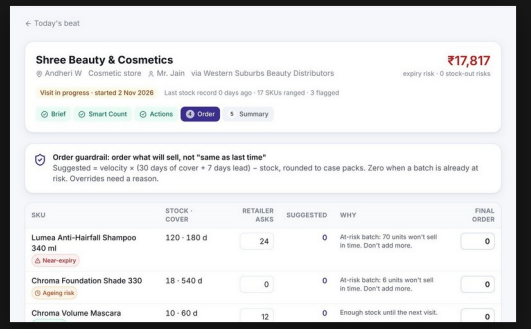
L'ORÉAL

A working product, not a concept: the rep's visit end to end

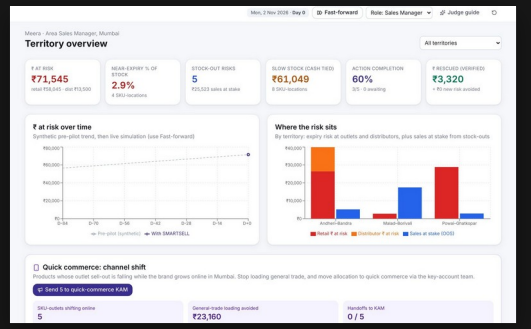




Smart Count on a phone



Order guardrail



Manager view: risk, approvals, channel shift

1 **Plain-English risk** ₹14,700 at risk · 75 days to act

2 **Cheapest step first** Pause re-order, ₹0

3 **Matched transfer** 66 units to a store about to run out

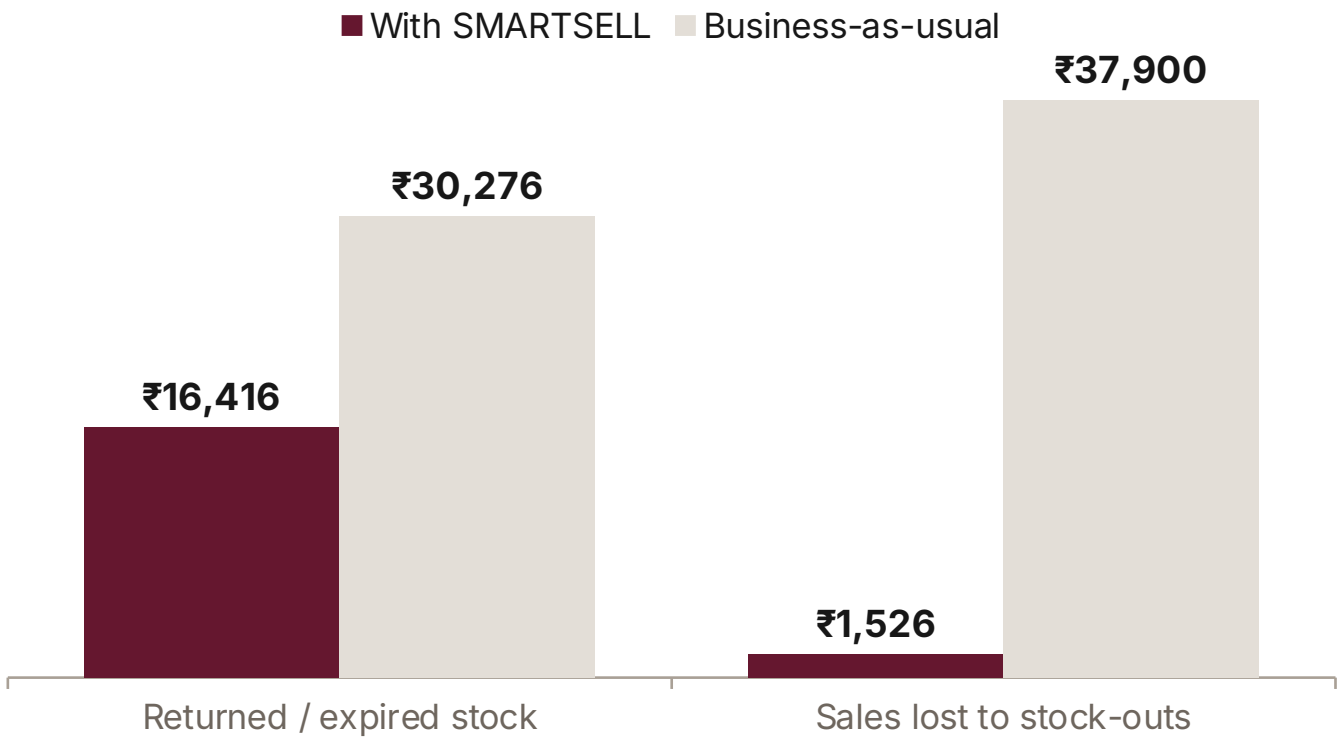
4 **Human decision** Accept, modify or reject with a reason

Try it live
smartsell-loreal.vercel.app
5-minute judge guide built in

Genuine screenshots of the live prototype (synthetic data; fictional brands Lumea, Verdé, Chroma, DermaPure, Salon Pro, Maison Éclat). Not connected to any L'Oréal system.

L'ORÉAL

In simulation, the same stock produces half the returns and far fewer empty shelves



After one quarter, ₹, synthetic territory

0.9% vs 1.6%

returns as % of sell-out (case cap ≈1.5%)

₹1,526 vs ₹37,900

sales lost to empty shelves

₹13,860

expiry risk rescued by one transfer

66 units

saved from reverse logistics and destruction

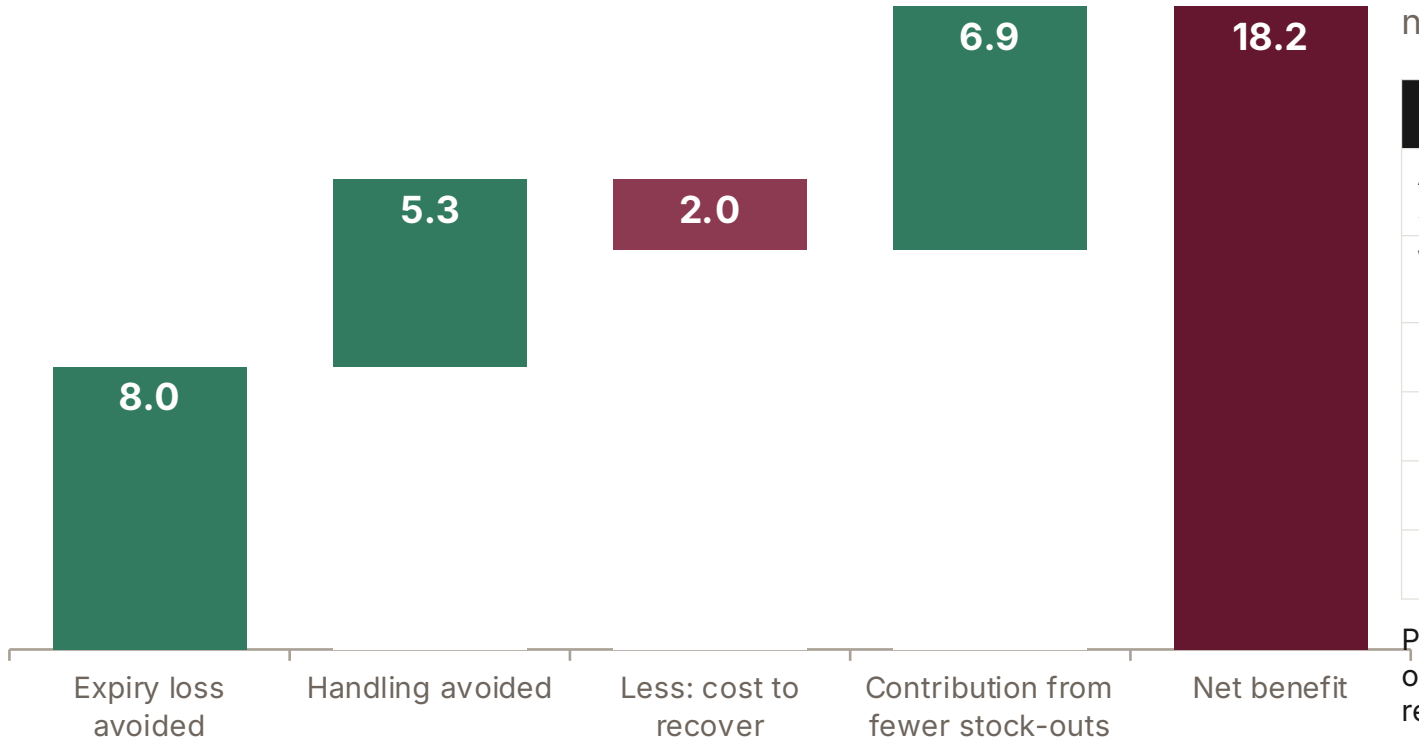
Fast-forward runs two worlds from the same stock: SMARTSELL (guardrail orders, transfers, interventions) vs business-as-usual ("same as last time" re-orders, retailer asks, no rebalancing).

Illustrative simulation in the prototype: synthetic Mumbai network (18 outlets, 3 distributors, 24 SKUs), 13 weeks, same starting stock, only the hero transfer accepted. Not a forecast of L'Oréal results.

L'ORÉAL

Base case: ≈₹18 cr a year net, with honest bounds

₹ cr per year, steady state. **Pool ₹147.5 cr (2.5% × ₹5,900 cr) → ≈36% addressable by field sales → 25% of that prevented**



₹18.2 cr

net benefit a year, base case (illustrative)

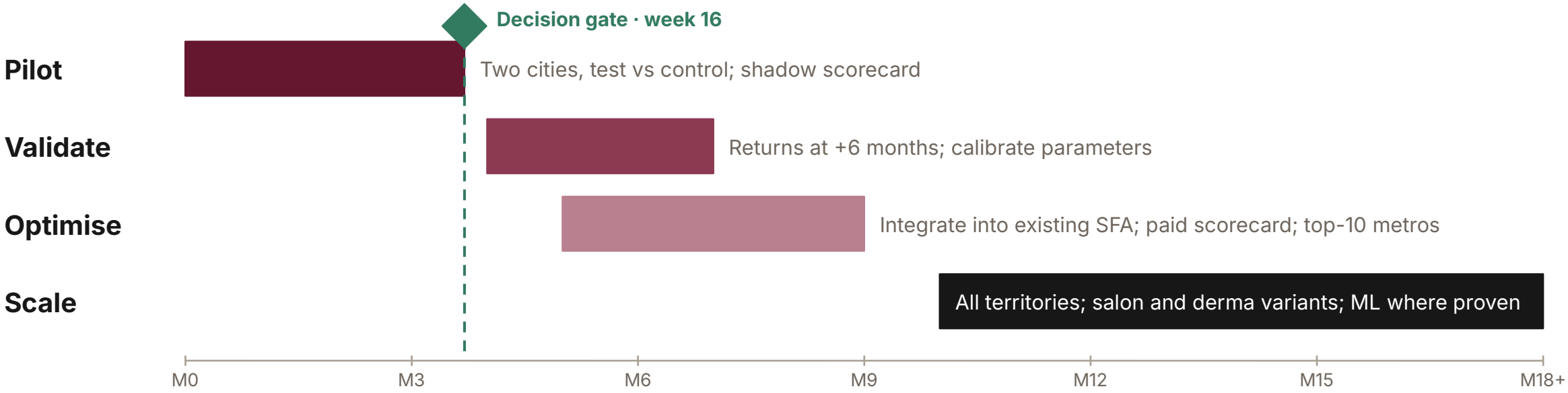
	Conservative	Base	Optimistic
Addressable share	25%	**36%**	46%
Waste prevented	15%	**25%**	35%
Net benefit/yr	₹7.3 cr	**₹18.2 cr**	₹32.8 cr
3-year cost	₹18.0 cr	**₹15.0 cr**	₹12.0 cr
3-year ROI	≈1%	**≈204%**	≈584%
Units saved/yr	≈1.3 lakh	**≈3.2 lakh**	≈5.6 lakh

Pays back in year 2 (year-1 ROI ≈ −9%). The conservative case only breaks even, hence a pilot with stop criteria. Waste reduction alone ≈₹11.3 cr a year.

Illustrative model (model/financial_model.py). Sourced inputs: case ≈1.5% and ≈1%; L'Oréal India FY25 net sales ≈₹5,925 cr (rounded to ₹5,900 cr). All other inputs are assumptions: see Appendix C. Excludes quick-commerce loading avoided (not modelled).

L'ORÉAL

A 16-week pilot that proves it, or stops it



Scale if at-risk ₹ down ≥20% vs control, stock-outs down ≥15%, secondary growth ≥ control, ≥70% of actions completed, ≤4 extra minutes per visit

Stop if at-risk ₹ improves <10%, or growth falls more than 2 points below control

Geography
Mumbai (quick-commerce heavy) + one tier-2 city, e.g. Nagpur or Indore

SKUs
40 focus SKUs: top 20 by past returns + top 20 by velocity

Technology
Prototype hardened into a PWA on a weekly DMS extract, or configured in the existing SFA

Coverage
4 test + 4 control distributors; ~600 outlets; ~12 reps

Training
1-day workshop, 2 ride-along days per rep, weekly ASM huddle

Measurement
Test vs control; weekly leading KPIs; returns at +6 months

Pilot design and budget are proposals to agree with L'Oréal (≈₹50 lakh: build ₹20 L, data ₹10 L, training ₹5 L, intervention budget ₹10 L, measurement ₹5 L). Returns are a lagging metric, so they are re-measured at +6 months.

L'ORÉAL

One scorecard for growth and waste, owned by the sales line

GROWTH

Incremental contribution & ROI	(Test – control growth) × margin – costs	**≥ control**
Sell-through	Units sold ÷ (opening + receipts)	**+10% on flagged SKUs**

WASTE

Expiry & return rate	₹ returned ÷ ₹ secondary sales	**–15% at +6 mo**
At-risk inventory value	Σ projected unsold × unit value	**–25%**
Inventory recovered	₹ of at-risk stock sold via transfer, bundle or activation	**Tracked**

AVAILABILITY

Stock-out rate	Must-stock SKUs at zero ÷ checked	**–20%**
Days of inventory	Stock ÷ daily sell-out	**Within norm ±20%**

EXECUTION

Intervention completion	Actions done ÷ accepted	**≥70%**
Visit time added	Extra minutes at flagged outlets	**≤4 min**

HEALTHY SALES SCORECARD · REP INCENTIVE



Availability 15% · Execution 15%

GOVERNANCE CADENCE

Daily rep actions · **Weekly** ASM approvals, coaching · **Monthly** distributor ageing, brand readout · **Quarterly** leadership scorecard, returns and scheme policy

Targets are pilot proposals measured against control territories. Scorecard weights are assumptions to agree with L'Oréal sales leadership.

From order collection to intelligent demand and inventory management

Selling more into the channel	→	**Moving the right stock to the right shelf**
Finding waste at the return	→	**Catching it while the fix is cheap**
Discount as the default	→	**Discount as the guarded last resort**
Quick commerce as a threat	→	**Quick commerce as a planning signal**

Every unit that sells instead of expiring is waste avoided at the top of the hierarchy, before any recycling, in line with L'Oréal for the Future.

Our ask: one distributor-data extract, two territories, 16 weeks.
Try it: smartsell-loreal.vercel.app

L'ORÉAL

Evidence, methodology and Q&A

A Sources and data integrity

B Risk methodology and parameters

C Financial model assumptions and sensitivity

D The five playbooks

E Five biggest risks and how we address them

F Likely judge questions

G Solution options we considered

L'ORÉAL

What is fact, what is research, what is our estimate

- **Case fact**
  From the L'Oréal brief: ≈1.5% returns/expired/damaged; ≈1% handling; field teams see distributor and retailer inventory
- **Research finding**
  Public, dated sources (right). India unless marked global
- **Estimate**
  Our modelled numbers: financial scenarios, addressable shares, uplifts
- **Synthetic**
  All prototype data: fictional brands, outlets, people, online growth rates

Not publicly available (we did not invent these): L'Oréal India channel mix, distributor and outlet counts, field-force size, SFA/DMS stack, return-policy terms, or what "capped at ≈1.5%" means. These are pilot set-up questions.

Claim	Source, date
L'Oréal India FY24 revenue ₹5,576 cr; FY25 net sales ₹5,925 cr, profit ₹597.5 cr	Indiaretailing, 27 Nov 2024; PTI/The Week, 3 Oct 2025
India +14% LFL (H1 2025), +17% (H1 2026); SAPMENA-SSA +10.9% (2025)	L'Oréal half-year results; 2025 URD
Quick commerce a focus; CeraVe and La Roche-Posay expanding	Business Standard, 25 Oct 2026
E-com 18% of FMCG in top-8 metros; q-comm >¾ of e-com; kirana volume +1.1%	NielsenIQ Q4 2025 snapshot, Mar 2026
Dabur cut distributor stock 30 → 21 days; halted primary 7–8 days	Sharekhan 30 Oct 2024; Baroda Securities 31 Oct 2024
AICPDF alleges near-expiry dumping via quick commerce	Storyboard18, Nov 2024 (allegation)
HUL Shikhar: 1.4 m retailers; dormancy challenges	Unilever 2023; WARC
Cosmetics labels must carry use-before / expiry date	CDSCO Cosmetics Rules 2020 (amended 2025)
Packaging 33% recycled, 44% recycled or bio-based (2025)	L'Oréal 2025 URD
Out-of-stock: ≈8% average; ≈1 in 3 shoppers switch or don't buy	Gruen, Corsten & Bharadwaj 2002 (global)

Full source register with URLs: research folder, sources.md. Some claims were verified from search summaries of the named pages; re-open before external use. Global data is labelled as such.

L'ORÉAL

Every flag can be traced to five inputs and four parameters

Parameter	Outlet	Distributor	Why
Minimum sellable buffer	30 days	120 days	Shoppers and retailers avoid packs close to expiry; distributor stock still has to reach a shelf
Target days of cover	30	21	Distributor norm in line with publicly corrected FMCG levels
Reorder point	≤14 days	≤12 days	Lead time 7 days + safety stock
Overstock	>2× norm	>2× norm	Cash tied up even when it sells in time
Channel-shift cover norm	21 days	—	Outlet −20% in 3 months while online grows +20%
Confidence	Scan/DMS 1.0 · count 0.85 · verbal 0.5		Recency: ≤7 d ×1.0, ≤30 d ×0.8, older ×0.5; Low locks costly actions

LIMITATIONS WE STATE OPENLY

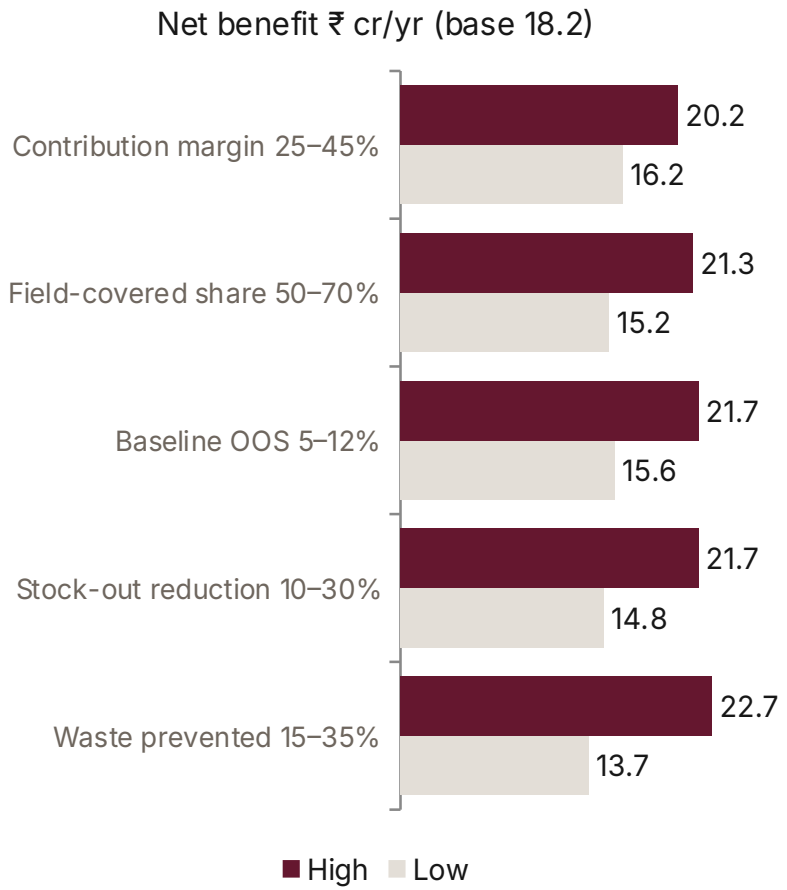
Velocity is assumed constant over the window (a trend factor and ML forecasts come later); stock-flow sell-out is noisy, so anomalies are flagged and confidence-weighted; buffers and norms are assumptions to calibrate against L'Oréal's return terms; the engine recommends and people decide.

Reference implementation: model/risk_engine_reference.py (Python) and lib/engine.ts (prototype). Unit tests check the worked examples.

L'ORÉAL

Assumptions behind the ₹18 cr base case, and what moves it most

Input	Conservative	Base	Optimistic	Basis
Revenue base	₹5,900 cr	**₹5,900 cr**	₹5,900 cr	L'Oréal India FY25 net sales, rounded (sourced)
Waste pool	1.5% + 1%	**1.5% + 1%**	1.5% + 1%	Case (sourced)
Field-covered share	50%	**60%**	70%	Assumption
Sales-influenceable share	50%	**60%**	65%	Assumption; validate with return reason codes
Waste prevented	15%	**25%**	35%	Assumption; pilot measures it
Cost to recover stock	35%	**25%**	20%	Of loss avoided
Stock-out reduction	10%	**20%**	30%	On an 8% OOS base, 35% brand loss (global study)
Contribution margin	35%	**35%**	35%	Assumption
Build + year-1 run	₹12.0 cr	**₹10.0 cr**	₹8.0 cr	Assumption; lower if configured in existing SFA



Model: model/financial_model.py; outputs in model/scenarios.csv. Double-counting rules: transferred units counted once (as avoided credit notes, never also as extra sales); stock-out benefit at contribution margin; distributor working capital excluded.

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Each risk state gets its own sequence, cost and guardrail

Playbook	Sequence	Main risk	Guardrail
Near-expiry	Verify batch → pause re-order → transfer projected-unsold units to the fastest outlets → approved bundle → controlled end-of-life if <30 days	Pushing short-dated stock onto retailers who return it	Transfer capped at recipient's sell-through capacity
Slow-moving (healthy shelf life)	Diagnose (reason code) → visibility → tester or sampling → cap re-orders → range correction → rebalance if no change in 2 visits	Acting on the wrong diagnosis	Re-measure velocity at the next 2 visits
Overstocked node	SKU-level cover review → guardrail on over-covered SKUs only → rebalance → reset norms by SKU class	Revenue cliff from blanket cuts	Fast SKUs keep ordering
Stock-out risk	Source from surplus outlets first → replenish to cover + lead time → raise beat frequency	Over-correcting into excess	Capped at target cover
Poor visibility / channel shift	Benchmark peers → placement and testers → or, if demand moved online, resize orders and hand off to quick-commerce KAM	Blaming the product for an execution or channel issue	Never dump ageing stock on quick commerce

Approval thresholds: transfers above ₹10,000 or across distributors, any scheme, sampling budget and end-of-life need ASM approval. Luxe and Derma: no price schemes; Luxe: no bundles.

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The five biggest risks to SMARTSELL, and how we address them

	RISK	WHY IT MIGHT HAPPEN	HOW WE ADDRESS IT
1	**Reps won't adopt it**	Extra time, "another app", incentives still pay for sell-in	Count flagged SKUs only (≤4 min is a stop criterion); embed in existing SFA; Healthy Sales Scorecard; credit for ₹ rescued
2	**Data is poor**	No POS in general trade, missing batches, stale counts	Stock-flow sell-out; confidence weighting; "verify first" locks costly actions; DMS as the base layer
3	**Unintended consequences**	Discount habit, brand dilution, channel conflict, under-ordering	Discount is step 6 of 8; no schemes for Luxe/Derma; transfers within authorised network; growth guardrail KPI vs control
4	**L'Oréal already has systems**	SFA/DMS and central demand sensing exist	SMARTSELL is a logic and workflow layer the current SFA can host; it feeds outlet signals into demand planning
5	**Benefits are overstated**	Estimates mistaken for results	Only case % are sourced; three scenarios with a break-even conservative case; pilot with stop criteria

Each mitigation is built into the prototype or the pilot design.

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Short answers to the questions we expect

We already have an SFA and DMS. Why this?

They capture orders and stock. SMARTSELL adds the decision layer: batch-level risk at the outlet, sanctioned actions, and verified outcomes. Your SFA can host it.

Where is the AI?

Deliberately rules-first so it can be audited. ML comes in phase 3 for sparse-SKU forecasts and learning which action works where.

Reps visit 20 outlets a day. They won't count.

They count only flagged SKUs at flagged outlets. Batch dates are printed by law, so reading one takes seconds. ≤4 minutes is a stop criterion.

Doesn't a transfer just move the problem?

Only if you send too much. Quantity is capped at what the recipient can sell before its own buffer date.

What about quick commerce?

We detect demand moving online, tighten general-trade orders there and hand off to the quick-commerce KAM. We never dump short-dated stock online.

Is the ₹18 cr real?

No. It's an illustrative base case built only on the case percentages and labelled assumptions. The pilot measures the real number.

Full answers: research folder, 12-judge-qa.md, and deck/presenter-pack.md.

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Why a hybrid beats tech-only or process-only

Criterion (weight)	Tech-led AI platform	Process-led playbook	Hybrid: SMARTSELL	Policy-led returns
Business impact (25%)	4	3	**5**	2
Feasibility in 6–12 months (20%)	2	5	**4**	4
Answers the case brief (20%)	2	4	**5**	2
Differentiation (15%)	3	2	**5**	1
Scalability (10%)	4	2	**4**	5
Judge demo appeal (10%)	4	1	**5**	1
Weighted score	**3.05**	**3.15**	**4.70**	**2.45**

Tech-only answers a question the case didn't ask (L'Oréal already runs central demand sensing). Process-only can't rebalance across outlets or measure outcomes. Policy-only shifts the cost to distributors instead of removing waste.

Weights and scores are our judgement (1–5). Weighted: tech-led 0.25·4+0.20·2+0.20·2+0.15·3+0.10·4+0.10·4 = 3.05, and so on. Judges are welcome to re-weight.